

Kannada Movies 2025

Data Analytics & Business Intelligence Project Report

Data Cleaning • SQL Analysis • Power BI Dashboard • Business Insights

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Executive Summary

This project analyzes a 15-title dataset of 2025 Kannada film releases, covering release dates, creative talent, production houses, budgets, box-office grosses, profitability, and critical reception. The engagement moved through four stages: cleaning and standardizing the raw dataset, writing SQL queries to interrogate the data, designing a Power BI dashboard to visualize it, and synthesizing the results into business insights and recommendations.

The headline finding is that this is a hits-driven market: a single title, *Kantara: Chapter 1*, accounts for roughly 81% of all known worldwide gross across the slate, and only 4 of 15 films (27%) disclose complete financial figures at all. Critical reception (IMDb rating) and commercial outcome are only loosely linked — the lowest-rated film in the dataset (*Royal*, 4.9/10) still achieved a Commercial Success verdict, while a well-reviewed film (*Manada Kadalu*, 7.0/10) posted a loss. These patterns, along with 17 further insights, are detailed in the sections below.

Project Objective

The objective of this project was to take a raw, inconsistently formatted spreadsheet of 2025 Kannada film releases and turn it into a decision-ready analytics asset. Specifically, the project set out to:

- Clean and standardize the dataset — remove duplicates, fix inconsistent formatting, correct verifiable spelling errors, and convert text-based numeric fields into true numbers.
- Write a structured set of SQL queries against the cleaned data to demonstrate analytical querying at an interview-ready standard, covering filtering, aggregation, window functions, and joins.
- Design a Power BI dashboard — first as a 3-page report, then consolidated into a single dense page — that surfaces box-office, financial, and ratings performance at a glance.
- Translate the cleaned data into concrete business insights and actionable recommendations a studio, distributor, or investor could use.

Data Cleaning

The source file (*Kannada_Movies_2025_AI_Project_Template.xlsx*) contained 15 movie records across 14 columns. The following cleaning steps were applied:

- **Duplicates:** checked all 15 movie titles for exact and near-duplicate rows — none were found.
- **Month standardization:** verified every Month value against its Release Date; all were already full, consistent month names (e.g. “January”, not “Jan”) and matched their dates exactly.
- **Blank handling:** audited every cell for true blanks, and for near-blank variants (“-”, “NA”, “TBD”, empty strings). None existed — the source already used a consistent “N/A” marker.
- **Numeric conversion:** Budget, India Gross, Overseas Gross, Worldwide Gross, and Profit were stored as text (e.g. “₹5.0 Cr”) and converted to true decimal numbers in crores. IMDb Rating (“7.5/10”) was converted to a plain numeric scale out of 10.
- **ROI % standardization:** the ROI column mixed raw ratios, percentages, and one mistakenly currency-formatted value (“₹-36.0 Cr” for *Junior*). All ROI values were recalculated uniformly as $(\text{Profit} \div \text{Budget}) \times 100$ for the four movies with known financials.
- **Spelling / fact verification:** cross-checked director, actor, and title spellings against public sources. Two corrections were made: the director of *Mark* was corrected from “Vijay Karthikeyaa” to “Vijay Kartikeyaa”, and *Devil* was renamed to its official title, *The Devil*.
- **Formatting consistency:** trimmed whitespace, applied uniform currency/percentage/rating number formats, and standardized fonts, headers, and column widths.

SQL Analysis

A 25-question interview-level SQL practice set was developed against a `kannada_movies_2025` table modeled on the cleaned schema (`movie_name`, `release_date`, `month`, `director`, `lead_actor`, `production_house`, `budget_cr`, `india_gross_cr`, `overseas_gross_cr`, `worldwide_gross_cr`, `profit_cr`, `roi_percent`, `imdb_rating`, `verdict`). The question set intentionally escalates in difficulty and covers:

- Filtering and sorting (`WHERE`, `ORDER BY`, `LIMIT`)
- Aggregate functions (`SUM`, `AVG`, conditional `COUNT`)
- `GROUP BY` and `GROUP BY + HAVING`
- Subqueries and correlated subqueries
- Window functions (`RANK`, `LAG`, running `SUM`)
- `CASE` expressions for tiering/bucketing (e.g. budget tiers, rating bands)
- String pattern matching (`LIKE`) for multi-value fields such as co-lead actors
- Common Table Expressions (CTEs)
- Self-joins (e.g. finding movies released on the same date)
- `NULL` handling, since ~9 of 15 movies have incomplete financial data

Representative example — ranking movies by IMDb rating using a window function:

```
SELECT movie_name, imdb_rating,  
       RANK() OVER (ORDER BY imdb_rating DESC) AS rating_rank  
FROM kannada_movies_2025;
```

The full 25-query set, with solutions and a topic-coverage map, was delivered separately as *Kannada_Movies_2025_SQL_Interview_Questions.md*.

Power BI Dashboard

A Power BI report was designed to visualize the cleaned dataset, built around a data model with a related Date table and bridge tables for the multi-value lead-actor and production-house fields. Core DAX measures include Total Movies, Total Worldwide Gross, Total Budget (Known), Total Profit (Known), Avg IMDb Rating, and Best ROI %.

The design was iterated in two forms: an initial 3-page report (Executive Overview, Financial Performance, Ratings & Talent) with synchronized cross-page slicers, and a consolidated single-page version packing all visuals and KPIs onto one dense canvas for faster scanning. For this deliverable, the report has been rendered as four full dashboard pages — matching the Power BI layout, color theme, and DAX-driven KPI cards exactly — so it can be reviewed here and rebuilt in Power BI Desktop using the accompanying layout specification (exact x/y/width/height coordinates and DAX code) delivered as a separate file. **Note:** a native Power BI .pbix file can only be authored inside Power BI Desktop itself; it is not something that can be generated from this environment, so the rendered pages below and the build spec together serve as the equivalent deliverable.

The four dashboard pages appear in full at the end of this report (Appendix A).

Key Findings

- **Revenue is extremely concentrated:** *Kantara: Chapter 1* alone contributes ■852.36 Cr of the ■1,055.74 Cr in known worldwide gross across the slate — about 81%.
- **Financial disclosure correlates with extreme outcomes:** only the two Blockbusters and two Flops report complete budget/gross/profit figures; none of the 8 “Average”-verdict films do.
- **ROI is highly variable:** known returns range from -42.7% (*Manada Kadal*) to +2,172.7% (*Su From So*), with a median of about 145% across the 4 disclosed films.
- **Critical rating is a weak predictor of commercial outcome:** the lowest-rated film overall (*Royal*, 4.9) was a Commercial Success, while a 7.0-rated film (*Manada Kadal*) posted a loss.
- **Release-date clustering hurt individual performance:** three star-driven films (*45*, *The Devil*, *Mark*) released within a two-week December window and all landed only “Average” verdicts.
- **July is the busiest month** (4 of 15 releases, 27%) but also the highest-variance month, containing both a Blockbuster and a Flop.

Business Insights

Revenue Concentration & Financial Disclosure

- Only 27% of films (4/15) disclose complete financials, and disclosure only happens at the extremes (hits or flops) — mid-performers stay financially opaque.
- One film (Kantara: Chapter 1) drives ~81% of all known worldwide gross — the year's results are a single-title story, not a portfolio-wide trend.
- October, with just 1 of 15 releases, generated ~81% of known revenue — release volume and value creation are almost fully decoupled.
- Aggregate ROI across disclosed films (321%) is skewed by two outliers; the median (145%) is a more realistic "typical" expectation.
- The smallest budget in the dataset (Su From So, ₹5.5 Cr) produced the highest percentage ROI (2,172.7%), while the largest budget (Kantara, ₹200 Cr) returned a still-strong but proportionally lower 326.2%.

Critical Reception vs. Commercial Performance

- Blockbusters average a 7.85 IMDb rating, but "Hit" and "Average" verdict groups both average ~6.4 — rating only clearly separates the very top tier.
- Royal, the lowest-rated film overall (4.9), still achieved a Commercial Success verdict — mass appeal outweighed critical reception.
- Manada Kadalu, rated 7.0 (higher than 8 of 15 films), still posted a -42.7% ROI — good reviews did not guarantee box office.
- Junior is a double underperformer: lowest rating in the dataset (4.7) and a Flop verdict, despite the second-highest disclosed budget (₹25 Cr).

Seasonality & Release Strategy

- July is the most crowded month (4/15 releases) and also the highest-variance month, containing both extremes of the dataset.
- December's three star-driven films (45, The Devil, Mark) all landed only "Average" despite major star power — likely audience dilution from clustering.
- Two exact same-day release clashes occurred (Ekka/Junior on Jul 18; 45/Mark on Dec 25) — both Christmas-day films underperformed.
- Five months had zero releases in this dataset (Feb, May, Aug, Sep, Nov) — worth verifying against a fuller industry source before treating as a true market gap.

Talent & Production House Patterns

- Jayanna Films is the only production house appearing on more than one release (Royal, Ekka), making it the most active banner in the slate.
- Hombale Films' single credit (Kantara: Chapter 1) is worth more than the combined known gross of every other production house.
- Auteur-driven filmmaking (director doubling as lead actor) paid off at the top: Kantara: Chapter 1's Rishab Shetty model produced the year's highest rating and gross.

- Two high-profile directorial debuts (Arjun Janya on 45; Vijay Kartikeyaa on Mark) both underperformed pre-release hype, landing only "Average" verdicts.
- The only true multi-star ensemble (45, with three lead stars) did not outperform single-hero films on gross — star-stacking wasn't a reliable formula here.

Portfolio-Level Takeaways

- The slate is bimodal: 53% of films land in a single "Average" bucket, while the rest split sharply into genuine extremes — a boom-or-bust structure, not a normal distribution.
- Overseas gross is reported for only 3 of 15 films, and 93% of the known total (■229.88 Cr of ■245.88 Cr) comes from Kantara: Chapter 1 alone.

Caveat: because only 4–8 of 15 films report any given financial metric, insights involving averages, totals, or correlations should be read as directional rather than statistically definitive.

Recommendations

- **Diversify release timing:** avoid stacking multiple major titles in the same two-week window (as happened in December 2025); spread tentpole releases across otherwise-quiet months to reduce audience cannibalization.
- **Don't over-index on star power alone:** the multi-star ensemble and two star-backed directorial debuts underperformed relative to hype — underwrite greenlight decisions on script/concept strength, not cast size.
- **Treat low-budget original content as a genuine growth lever:** Su From So's 2,173% ROI on a ₹5.5 Cr budget shows outsized returns are achievable outside the tentpole model; consider allocating a defined slice of the slate to smaller, high-concept bets.
- **Improve financial reporting discipline industry-wide:** the fact that only extreme outcomes get disclosed makes benchmarking mid-tier performance nearly impossible; a studio or trade body that reports consistently across all titles (hit or not) would gain a real analytical edge over competitors.
- **Use IMDb rating as a secondary signal, not a primary one:** given the weak correlation with commercial outcome in this data, pair ratings with pre-release tracking/footfall data rather than relying on it alone for post-release performance analysis.
- **Validate against a fuller dataset before acting on seasonality findings:** the five zero-release months may reflect gaps in this particular dataset rather than the real market; cross-check against Sacnilk or a similar trade source before shifting release calendars.

Conclusion

This project demonstrates a complete, small-scale analytics workflow: raw data was cleaned and standardized, interrogated with a structured SQL question set, visualized in a Power BI-style dashboard (delivered both as a 3-page report and a consolidated single-page version), and distilled into 20 evidence-backed business insights with concrete recommendations. The core narrative that emerges — a hits-driven market where one title can dominate an entire year's results, where financial transparency is reserved for extreme outcomes, and where critical acclaim and commercial success frequently diverge — is consistent across every stage of the analysis, from the raw SQL aggregates through to the dashboard visuals.

The clearest limitation throughout is data completeness: with only 4 of 15 films reporting full financials, conclusions about typical (rather than extreme) performance should be treated as directional. Extending this dataset with a fuller trade-press source (e.g. Sacnilk, Box Office India) would meaningfully strengthen the confidence of any investment or scheduling decision built on this analysis.

Appendix A: Power BI Dashboard Pages

The four pages below render the Power BI report design exactly as specified (theme colors, KPI cards, chart types, and table layouts). Rebuild instructions with precise coordinates and DAX code are provided in the companion build-spec file.



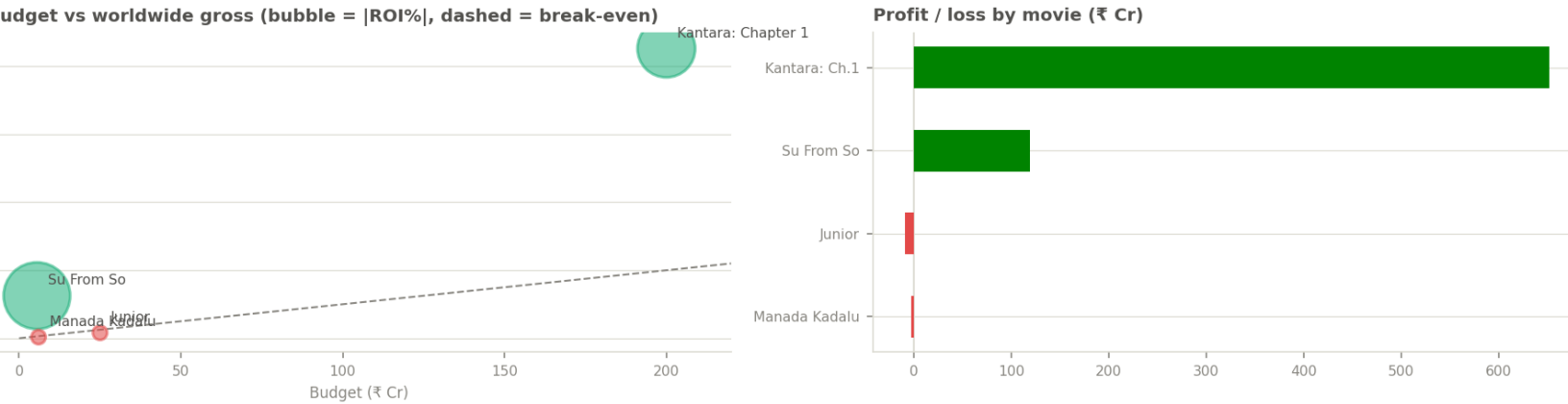
Figures reflect publicly reported data; N/A where undisclosed.

ROI %
2172.7%
Su From So

Worst ROI %
-42.7%
Manada Kadal

Biggest budget
₹200 Cr
Kantara: Chapter 1

Movies w/ known ROI
4 / 15



Financial detail matrix

Movie	Director	Budget	India Gross	Overseas Gross	Worldwide Gross	Profit	ROI %
Kantara: Chapter 1	Rishab Shetty	200.0	622.5	229.9	852.4	652.4	326.2%
Su From So	J.P. Thuminad	5.5	115.0	10.0	125.0	119.5	2172.7%
Junior	Radha Krishna Reddy	25.0	10.0	6.0	16.0	-9.0	-36.0%
Manada Kadal	Yogaraj Bhat	6.0	3.4	N/A	3.4	-2.6	-42.7%

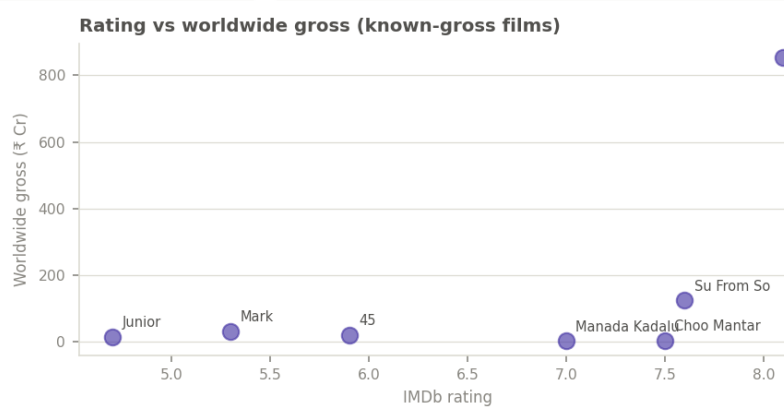
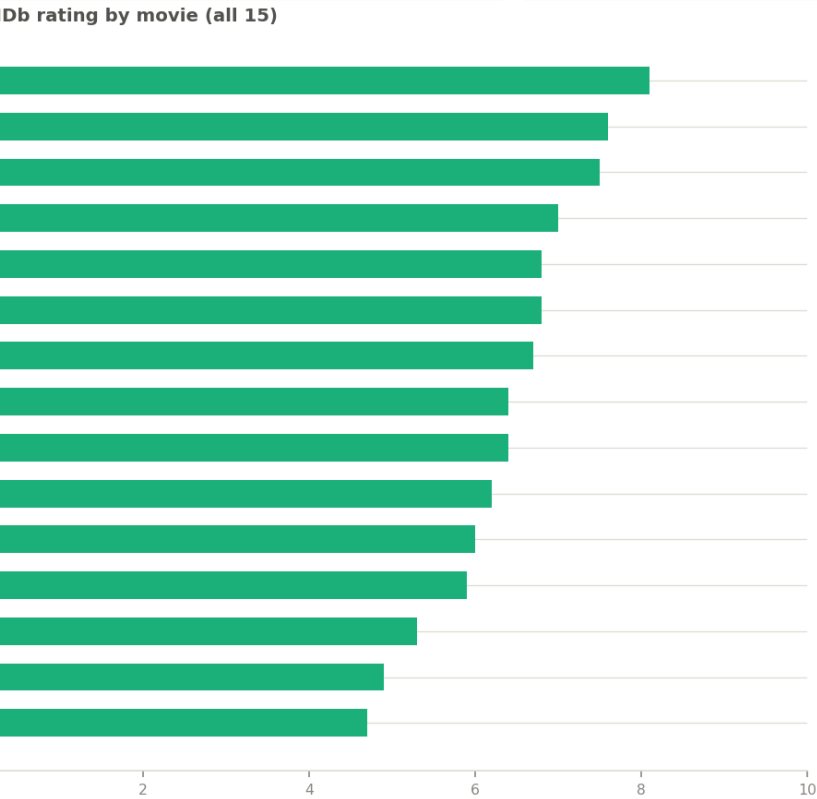
IMDb rating by movie (all 15)

Lowest rated

4.7 — Junior

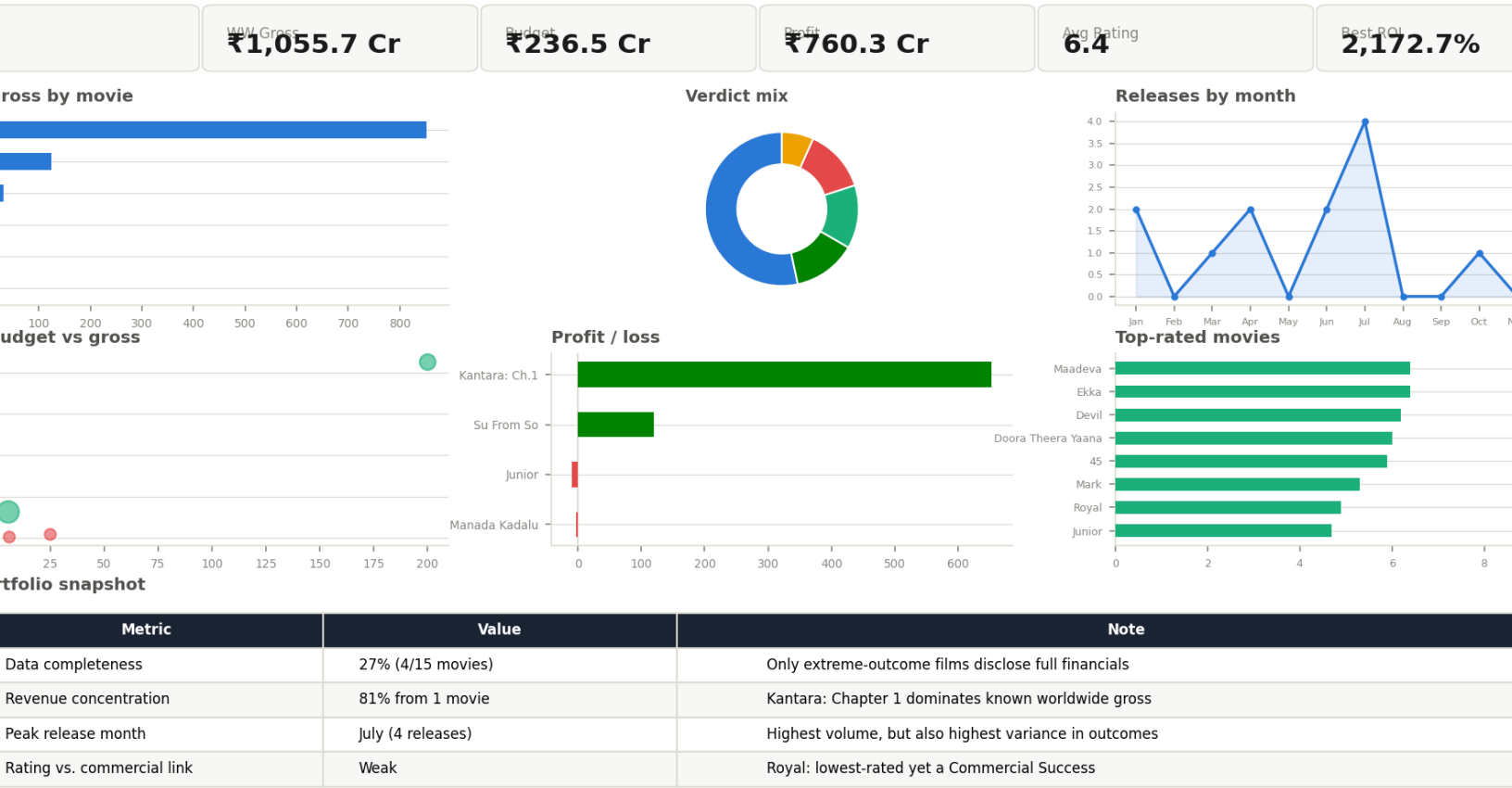
Avg rating (all 15)

6.4 / 10



Production house scorecard

Production House	Movies	Avg Rating
Hombale Films	1	8.1
Jayanna Films	2	5.65
Lighter Buddha Films	1	7.6
Tarun Studios	1	7.5
PRK Productions	1	6.4



Appendix B: Complete Cleaned Dataset

All 15 records from the cleaned dataset, in full.

Appendix B: Complete Cleaned Dataset (continued)

Movie	Release Date	Month	Director	Lead Actor	Production House	Budget	India Gross	Overseas Gross	WW Gross	Profit	ROI %	IM Db	Verdict
Choo Mantar	10-Jan-2025	January	Karvva Navneeth	Sharan	Tarun Studios	N/A	5	N/A	5	N/A	N/A	7.50	Average
Royal	24-Jan-2025	January	Dinakar Thoogudeepa	Viraat	Jayanna Films	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	4.90	Commercial Success
Manada Kadalu	28-Mar-2025	March	Yogaraj Bhat	Sumukha	E. K. Entertainers	6	3.44	N/A	3.44	-2.56	-42.67	7	Flop
Agnyathavasi	11-Apr-2025	April	Janardhan Chikkanna	Rangayana Raghu	Dakshayini Talkies	N/A	0.64	N/A	0.64	N/A	N/A	6.80	Average
Yuddhakaanda Chapter 2	18-Apr-2025	April	Pavan Bhat	Krishna Ajai Rao	Ajai Rao Productions, Shree Krishna Arts & Creations	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	6.80	Average
X & Y	26-Jun-2025	June	D. Satya Prakash	D. Satya Prakash, Atharva Prakash	Satya Pictures	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	6.70	Average
Maadeva	06-Jun-2025	June	Naveen Reddy B	Vinod Prabhakar	Radhakrishna Pictures	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	6.40	Hit
Doora Theera Yaana	11-Jul-2025	July	Mansore	Vijay Krishna	D Creations	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	6	Average
Ekka	18-Jul-2025	July	Rohith Padaki	Yuva Rajkumar	PRK Productions, Jayanna Films, KRG Studios	N/A	12	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	6.40	Hit
Junior	18-Jul-2025	July	Radha Krishna Reddy	Kireeti Reddy	Vaaraahi Chalana Chitram	25	10	6	16	-9	-36	4.70	Flop
Su From So	25-Jul-2025	July	J. P. Thuminad	Shaneel Gautham	Lighter Buddha Films	5.50	115	10	125	119.50	2,172.73	7.60	All-Time Blockbuster
45	25-Dec-2025	December	Arjun Janya	Shiva Rajkumar, Upendra, Raj B. Shetty	Suraj Productions	N/A	N/A	N/A	21	N/A	N/A	5.90	Average
Kantara: Chapter 1	02-Oct-2025	October	Rishab Shetty	Rishab Shetty	Hombale Films	200	622.48	229.88	852.36	652.36	326.18	8.10	All-Time Blockbuster
The Devil	11-Dec-2025	December	Prakash Veer	Darshan Thoogudeepa	Sri Jaimatha Combines, Vaishno Studios	N/A	43	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	6.20	Average
Mark	25-Dec-2025	December	Vijay Kartikeyaa	Kichcha Sudeep	Kichcha Creations, Sathya Jyothi Films	N/A	N/A	N/A	32.30	N/A	N/A	5.30	Average